CULTIVATION GUIDE | VARIETIES

Rice Varieties: Age Classes and the Varieties in AgriVibe Fields

How the Department of Agriculture groups rice varieties by age, and the published characteristics of the varieties grown in AgriVibe's registered fields.

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Teaching edition for the STEMLink AI Engineer Bootcamp, compiled from official Sri Lankan sources (Department of Agriculture and RRDI web pages, Agricultural and Agrarian Insurance Board, Cabinet decisions as reported), accessed 3 October 2026. Sources are listed in the corpus README, not in this document.

1. Age classes

RRDI breeds varieties in age categories of two and a half, three, three and a half and four months. Ultra short age (two and a half month) varieties are developed for water shortage areas, and three month varieties are introduced to areas with less water. Three and a half month varieties are the most popular and cover the largest extent of rice cultivation in the country. Four month varieties are introduced where water is available throughout the season, to obtain a higher yield. The DOA also recommends four long age, photoperiod sensitive varieties.

The age class decides which fertiliser schedule column applies (AV-CG-06) and where the crop sits in its growth stages (AV-CG-04).

Examples on the DOA recommended list

- Three month: H 10, Bg 276-5, Bg 300, Bg 301, Bw 302, At 303, Bg 304, Bg 305, At 306 to At 309, Bg 310, At 311, Bg 314.
- Three and a half month: H 7, At 16, Bg 34-6, Bg 94-1, Bg 94-2, Bg 350, Bw 351, Bg 352, At 353, At 354, Ld 355, Ld 356, Bg 357.

2. Bg 300

Released 1987. Three month age class, maturity 93 days. Average yield 5.0 t/ha. Recommended for general cultivation. Intermediate bold grain with white pericarp.

Published resistance: moderately resistant to blast, bacterial leaf blight and brown planthopper; resistant to rice gall midge (biotype I).

3. Bg 352

Released 1992. Three and a half month age class, maturity 98 to 102 days. Average yield 4.9 t/ha. Recommended for general cultivation. Intermediate bold grain with white pericarp.

4. Bg 359

Released 1999. Maturity 103 to 105 days, which places it in the three and a half month age class. Average yield 5.9 t/ha. Recommended for the Wet Zone. Intermediate bold grain with white pericarp.

Published resistance: resistant to both rice gall midge biotypes (I and II).

5. Bg 94-1

On the DOA list of recommended three and a half month varieties.

VARIETIES AND THE ADVISORY BOUNDARY

A variety's published resistance lowers risk; it does not rule a pest or disease out, and it is not a diagnosis. Questions about whether a crop is affected by a pest or disease are routed to the Agriculture Instructor or the 1920 service (AV-POL-01).